

ITALY

ITALY WAS FIRST UNITED by the ancient Romans, whose great empire spread across Europe. But for much of its history, Italy has been a divided land. During the Middle Ages, it split into many separate states, not reuniting until 1861. This boot-shaped country stretches from the glaciers and lakes of the mountainous north to the rocky Mediterranean coastline of the hot south. Two Mediterranean islands, Sicily and Sardinia, both belong to Italy as well, but the group of islands to the south of Sicily make up the separate country of Malta. The mainland of Italy also includes two tiny independent states, San Marino and Vatican City.

Milan, Italy

Jan 36°F (3°C)
July 76°F (25°C)
Jan 1.6 in (44 mm)
July 2.5 in (64 mm)



SAN MARINO



VATICAN CITY

THINGS TO LOOK FOR ON THE MAP

Longest river: Po, 405 miles (652 km) Map B4

Highest active volcano in Europe: Mt. Etna, 10,705 ft (3,263 m) Map H13

Largest lake: L. Garda, 143 sq miles (370 sq km) Map D3

Brindisi, Italy

Jan 48.5°F (9°C)
July 77°F (25°C)
Jan 3 in (77 mm)
July 0.6 in (14 mm)



ITALY

Valletta, Malta

Jan 54°F (12°C)
July 78°F (25°C)
Jan 3.5 in (90 mm)
July 0 in (0 mm)

LANDSCAPE

The Alps sweep across the north of the region, and the Apennine Mountains form a central spine down the length of Italy, continuing beneath the sea to Sicily. Once covered in dense forest, much of the region's hills are now rocky scrubland, while the lowlands are used for growing crops.

